

Did You Know...? Sports Expressions - A1/A2 Version

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. The idioms (8)

Emoji	Idiom	Meaning
	Hold your horses!	Wait!
	Horsing around	Playing, being silly
	Get back in the saddle	Start again after a break
🐎	Champing at the bit	Very excited, can't wait
	The ball is in your court	It's your turn now
	Game, set, match	It's finished / won
	A slam dunk	An easy win, a sure thing
	A dark horse	A surprise winner

2. Matching activity

Students match each idiom to its meaning.

Idioms: Hold your horses! · Horsing around · Get back in the saddle · Champing at the bit · The ball is in your court · Game, set, match · A slam dunk · A dark horse

Meanings (mixed up): A. An easy win, a sure thing B. Wait! C. It's your turn now D. A surprise winner E. Very excited, can't wait F. Playing, being silly G. It's finished / won H. Start again after a break

3. Speaking - use it yourself

In pairs, students pick 3 idioms from the list and say a simple sentence with each, about their own life (school, family, friends).

Example: "Hold your horses! I'm not ready." / "My brother is always horsing around."

4. Fun fact (short, for everyone)

Most of these idioms come from horse riding, because for a very long time in English history, horses were not a hobby – they were transport and work. That's why English has so many horse idioms!

Companion file – the original sports-idioms-did-you-know.md is unchanged and should still be used with B1-B2 students (fuller idiom set, tennis/basketball idioms, and the "guess the sport" sorting task).

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Note for the teacher

Idioms are hard for true beginners – figurative meaning, no visual support in the words themselves. This version keeps only the most concrete, easy-to-picture idioms from the original set, adds an emoji anchor to each, and replaces the "guess the sport of origin" task (two steps: know the meaning AND know the sport) with a direct idiom meaning matching task (one step).

About this activity

Companion to `sports-idioms-did-you-know.md` – for A1-A2 students. Same idea (sports words that mean something else), but only 8 idioms, chosen for being the most concrete/visual, with a matching task instead of open discussion. ~10–15 min

2. Matching activity

1. 1-B, 2-F, 3-H, 4-E, 5-C, 6-G, 7-A, 8-D